



Working to relieve the pressure!

Awareness Month News

Awareness month was a great success, please continue to support us. A big thank you to all IIH UK Champions, members, fundraisers, social sharers, volunteers and all other IIH UK champions

Our virtual cafes were a and we are well attended and received great feedback we are working on bringing you more in the future.

Our September Awareness Month raffle raised an impressive £370 a Big thank you to everyone who bought a ticket or contributed prizes.

As a charity, we have lots to celebrate this year including the success of our June conference and weekender, as well as the continued brilliant research that is happening.

How to Help

Find out some free ways you can support us on Page 15

Membership Renewal

Don't forget that membership can now be renewed online.

https://www.iih.org.uk/product/107/7/membership_renewal



Read all About (or Re-live!) our 2025 Conference and Weekender



To open the hyperlinks in this newsletter from your lap top/PC simply hold down the ctrl key then left click the link or just tap the link from your smart phone.

Save the Date!

An exciting announcement about our much loved weekender! More details to follow.

Pop the weekend of the 5th to 7th of June 2026 in your diary with the main

**Saturday the
6th of June 2026**

IIH UK Weekender 2025

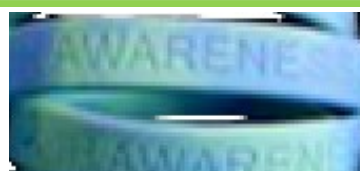
We are so grateful for everyone who attended our IIH UK conference and weekender in June of this year. The turn out was brilliant and it was lovely to see so many faces, both new and familiar. Our conference report is available to view on our website, and you can scroll to pages 8 and 9 for a summary. Look out for upcoming events soon!

Ways to Support us

We are so very grateful to all IIH UK champions. Despite being run solely by a small hardworking team of volunteers we need desperately need funds to enable us to carry out our vital work. Examples include our funding of the Hope programme for our members which research shows has a positive impact on people living with the impact of IIH. However we have been able to fund less this year; in particular we couldn't offer any research grants, I am certain you will join us in agreeing research is vital to finding more out about this life changing condition.

There are many ways to support us. We value your support in raising awareness both of IIH as a condition and us as a charity.

Pages 14-16 showcase the many ways that you can support us, some of which at no cost! At IIH UK we are a small charity, so appreciate any help, big and small. Our charity website is also a great place to shop for items with our logo, see below for some currently available items.



Important message from IIH UK.

- We want to talk about the importance of taking part in research.

We have recently learnt that the IIH Intervention trial has not recruited as many patients as it needs and if recruitment does not pick up it may be closed. This would be a disaster as we really need this research trial to answer an especially important question.

IIH is under-researched, and a 2015 Cochrane review found insufficient evidence to recommend or reject any current treatments used for treating people with IIH. In 2017 we collaborated with the James Lind Alliance to find the top 10 research priorities in IIH. By creating this priority setting partnership we aimed to identify the top 10 research priorities identified not just by doctors but by people with IIH and their carers.

You can read about it here <https://www.iih.org.uk/.../IIH-PSP-top-10-report.-final.pdf> and on the James Lind Website here <https://www.jla.nihr.ac.uk/priority-setting.../IIH/>

IIH UK's hope for the research priorities was to ensure that future research in IIH focused on questions and outcomes important to individuals with IIH and those treating them and ensure Funding is allocated to these areas.

#10 of the top ten research priorities is 'Which is the best type of intervention to treat IIH and when should surgery be performed?'. This brings us back to the IIH Intervention trial.

The question posed in this trial is : "Which is better to save vision in those with sight threatening IIH? CSF shunting or venous stenting?"

There are many centres around the world doing both of these procedures but there has NEVER EVER been a robust randomised trial comparing the procedures based on outcomes important to people with IIH. From listening to the people we support we know that it can be a postcode lottery, at the moment doctors do not know which is the best intervention, shunt or stent, and sometimes it can be down to the doctors or hospitals preference.

IIH UK supported the grant application for this trial because we know that having high quality research evidence is vital to decide which intervention is best for people with IIH based on research, not preference. On completion of this trial we will know which is the best procedure to save vision and ALSO which has the least risks and complications.

IIH is a rare disease and getting funding from national agencies to do research is extremely difficult. Clinical trials typically cost > £1.5 Million to conduct. To get research funding, the research idea has to compete in front of leading international scientists in a 'dragons' den' like situation with other diseases like cancer, dementia etc. The University of Birmingham led by Professor Sinclair have the funds for this trial and it would be a terrible waste for it to fail because of a recruitment issue. If the trial does not recruit it may force closure, it will also affect other future research bids in the area of IIH.

So, WE NEED YOUR HELP! Please spread the word to support the IIH Intervention Trial.

You can look at the eligibility criteria here <https://www.isrctn.com/ISRCTN57142415> to see if you are eligible. If you are eligible and are interested in taking part, please contact your IIH doctor and ask to be put forward to the trial.

Thank you.



Looking after the IIH
Brain is vital

We need research to
help Dr's make the best
clinical care decisions

IIH Intervention Trial: Which is best in IIH- CSF Shunting or Venous Stenting?

In 2021 IIH UK applied for and successfully received a £10,000 grant from The National Lottery Community fund to co-create the first self management programme for adults with IIH. Over the course of 2021 many people with IIH and health care professionals worked with The HOPE programme [HOPE PROGRAMME — Hope For The Community CIC \(h4c.org.uk\)](https://www.h4c.org.uk) to develop the course.

The new HOPE programme was launched in March 2022 and we were overwhelmed with applicants for the online programme so much so that a parallel course was set up. IIH UK also funded a parent carers course for parents of children with IIH.

Following the success of the initial programme all following courses have been solely funded by IIH UK.

The next programme for adults with IIH and their carers / parents will be in 2026. Visit <https://www.h4c.org.uk/courses-all/iih-140923> to find out more.



Praise and feedback for the HOPE programme include:

"It has given me a good insight into how others with the same condition manage on a daily basis. It has changed my way of thinking about living with the condition entirely."

"The programme has been a breath of fresh air and a place to explore the condition safely and confidently. The tasks, videos and information were really engaging and relevant. Thank you."

"The course has allowed me to reflect on my strengths and use those strengths to be a more productive and happy person; instead of sulking about the things I may not be able to do anymore, I have been able to begin a process of adapting to my limitations and finding new things to pursue and enjoy."

"This course has helped me to discover that I can still have a happy, hopeful and fulfilling life with my long-term health conditions. I do not have to let my conditions define me, but they are a part of me."

"I am more understanding of my own condition and that the feelings I have of uselessness are unfounded to some extent. I shouldn't beat myself up for not being ok every day. take my time and set myself simpler goals that are achievable."

A Few Words from the HOPE Programme Lead...

It was a pleasure to facilitate The IIHUK/HOPE Programme that started in April and ran for 6 weeks.

We had fantastic input from the people who took part in the programme, and it was great to see the positive impact that taking the HOPE programme had on those who took part.

What was particularly lovely to see was the amazing support that people gave each other in the group. There was so much positive encouragement given, particularly in supporting people to reach their goals each week. I loved seeing the photographs of people's goals which included gardens being restored, holidays being booked, cycling challenges being met, cakes being baked, cinema trips being taken and more!

It was also lovely to see the Gratitude Posts that people made, which particularly highlighted how important family, including the furry variety, are to those with a chronic illness such as IIH.

We had a wide range of people taking part in terms of age and how long they had been on their IIH journey. This meant that some of the newer members of the community were able to get support and information from those who had already trodden the path before them, which again gave them what they needed to continue their journey with more HOPE. - Laura Kerbey

Recent Feedback

'Very good opportunity to stop and think about YOU and coping strategies'

'Being diagnosed with IIH is scary as there is so little understanding amongst GP's. It helps to hear from specialists in the field and also learn new techniques to cope'



“I was angry at life” she remembers. “I felt lost. IIH is ‘idiopathic’- there aren’t any answers, no reason for it. Nobody understands what you’re going through. There was no-one who could really relate to the situation I was in. I was angry with the world”

Tanya heard about the HOPE programme from IIH UK. She shares her story of discovering the course on the [HOPE website](#).

Thank you to the [British Orthoptic Society](#) for promoting the HOPE programme for people with IIH. This is great news, as it means that clinicians looking after people with IIH will have more awareness of the course, and be able to recommend it to a wider range of people that may benefit.



BIOS | BRITISH AND IRISH
ORTHOPTIC SOCIETY

2025 IIH UK Conference and Weekender



2025 IIH UK Conference and Weekender

IIH UK welcomed attendees from around the UK to attend the first face to face conference since before Covid. Fondly called our “weekender”, we met those staying at the Hotel for a meal on the Friday night followed by drinks in the bar. Saturday was the main conference day and speakers from around the country talked about a range of topics related to IIH. We all learnt so much from the speakers and the interactive nature of many sessions got everyone joining in. After the talks on Saturday was dinner and another opportunity to catch up with old friends and make new ones. The opportunity to share and connect with others with IIH was very much appreciated.

Everyone at IIH UK gives a huge thanks to everyone who attended the weekender, including speakers and attendees. To everyone who was unable to attend, you can view our conference report on our website. Keep updated via our newsletter and social media channels to be the first to hear about upcoming events!

This years weekender was led with the focus of wellness, as we recognise the challenges in managing a long term condition, and therefore the importance of self care. The conference began with introductions from our chai and patron Shelly and Dr Sui Wong, shortly followed by some taster sessions of the Hope programme. Dr Sui Wong then spoke about mindfulness and brain health, whilst there were more sessions around mental health and movement. We also heard some great scientific and medical updates around the latest findings in headache, and the up-and-coming trial evaluating Mounjaro in IIH. We concluded our conference with a great talk around crystals and IIH with Hollie Clarke, and some insight into the work of IIH UK charity.

DontSendMeACard.com

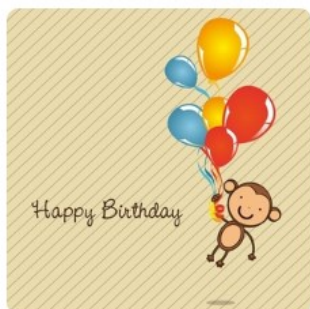
Have you any winter greetings to send? Birthdays? Christmas cards?

I love the idea of e-cards especially as I tend to leave my card sending until the last minute!

Don't send me a card is a fabulous way to send e-cards and support IIH UK at the same time. I was amazed to discover by donating just £2 I could send 5 e-cards, to different people and on different dates!

It is so easy to do!

All of your donation is received by the charity with an option to add a few pennies to support DontSendMeACard.com



Follow this link to find out more! <https://www.dontsendmeacard.com/ecards/charities/iih-uk>



Describing the impact of headache in the voices of people with Idiopathic Intracranial Hypertension (IIH) – A qualitative social media study.

“Valuable time is lost completely every day with IIH headaches that are totally debilitating and this makes me feel hopeless and helpless.”

We asked - ‘In one sentence explain how IIH headache has impacted/changed your life. How does it make you feel?’



Registered Charity in England and Wales: 1143522 and Scotland SC043294



Describing the impact of headache in the voices of people with Idiopathic Intracranial Hypertension (IIH) – A qualitative social media study.

“like a walking pharmacy, where I’m taking medications to overcome side effects from taking other medications with little hope for the future.”

We asked - ‘In one sentence explain how IIH headache has impacted/changed your life. How does it make you feel?’



Registered Charity in England and Wales: 1143522 and Scotland SC043294



Describing the impact of headache in the voices of people with Idiopathic Intracranial Hypertension (IIH) – A qualitative social media study.

“With IIH my life revolves around it. Sad, in constant pain, unhappy, unhealthy, annoyed.”

We asked - ‘In one sentence explain how IIH headache has impacted/changed your life. How does it make you feel?’



Registered Charity in England and Wales: 1143522 and Scotland SC043294



Describing the impact of headache in the voices of people with Idiopathic Intracranial Hypertension (IIH) – A qualitative social media study.

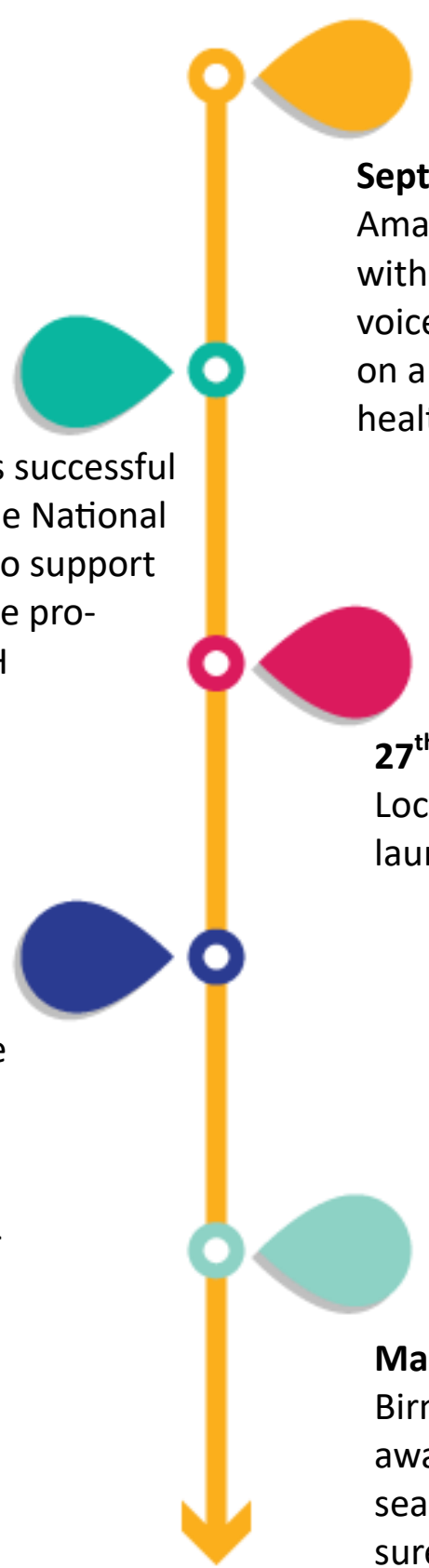
“IIH has changed my life drastically as I can no longer enjoy or physically do any daily activities without constant painful head pressure that lasts all day, everyday.”

We asked - ‘In one sentence explain how IIH headache has impacted/changed your life. How does it make you feel?’



Registered Charity in England and Wales: 1143522 and Scotland SC043294

In 2019 we undertook a survey asking 'What is the lived experience of headache in people with IIH. This IIH day we want to look back on some of the quotes that we collected.



A vertical timeline graphic consisting of a central orange line with a downward-pointing arrow at the bottom. Six colored teardrop shapes (orange, teal, pink, blue, light blue, and orange) are positioned along the line, each containing a white circle. The text blocks are placed to the left and right of the line, corresponding to the dates in the teardrops.

February 2022. IIH UK was successful in a grant application to the National Lottery Community Fund to support the development of a Hope programme for adults with IIH

September 2024. Shelly and Amanda were invited to chat with Sabrina at 'Raise your voice and you will be heard' on a podcast about mental health and IIH

27th June 2020. Our Life in Lockdown report was launched

July 2020. We asked the people we support, "In one sentence explain how IIH headache has impacted/changed your life." This poster was shared at the European Headache Congress 2020 Conference.

March 2020 Breaking News! Birmingham researcher awarded £1.68m to fund research in 'raised brain pressure'.

Support Available



Working to relieve the pressure!

I want to learn more
about Idiopathic
Intracranial
Hypertension

Leaflets

You can find a range of information leaflets on our website that are viewable online and available to print at home. They may be useful for showing to friends and family or to spread awareness. They can be found via the following link:

www.iih.org.uk/leaflets

Got a question about a neurological problem? Talk to one of the neuroscience nurses at the [Brain & Spine Foundation](http://www.brainandspine.org.uk)

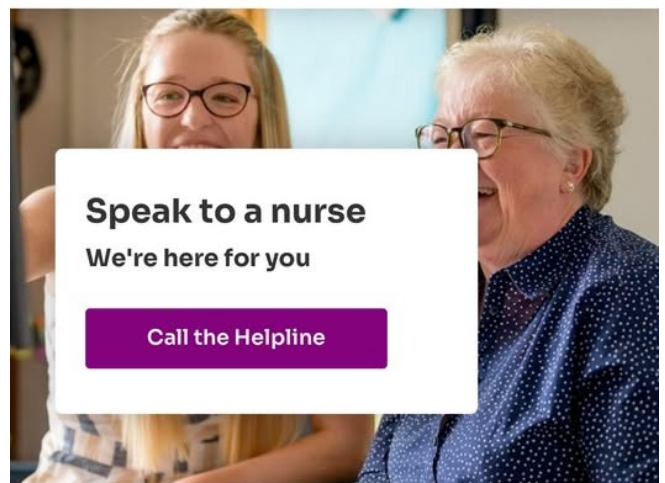
This resource has been invaluable to our members for medical and practical advice bringing support and often peace of mind when needed.

<https://www.brainandspine.org.uk/support-for-you/helpline/>

Talk to a nurse 0808 808 1000

Brain & Spine
Foundation

Donate



Our Fabulous Fundraising Champions!



A big SHOUT OUT to Nicola! She has taken on the challenge of walking 200,000 steps during Awareness Month to raise funds for us.

Thank you Nicola, you're a star!
Follow the link to read Nicola's story.
<https://www.justgiving.com/page/nicola-iih>

If you are doing a fundraiser for us please let us know so we can share it with our followers.

#working2relievethepressure
#IIHAwarenessMonth
#iih



Thankyou to
our Facebook
birthday
fundraisers!

**HAPPY
BIRTHDAY**

Thank you to Casey who hosted a summer craft fair this August in Cornwall in aid of IIH UK!



A big thank you to Kya Wilde who did a 300ft bungee jump this August and has so far raised £630 for us. You are incredible!

A big thank you to anyone not listed here, we could not continue the work we do without you.

If you have taken part in a fundraising event and would like it to appear on our website or in our newsletter please email fundraising@iih.org.uk or newsletter@iih.org.uk to let us know all about it.

DONATE

YOUR OLD OR FOREIGN COINS & BANKNOTES

TO HELP



Send to: IIH UK, 19 Woburn, Washington, Tyne and Wear, NE38 7JX

- ✓ All foreign coins & banknotes
- ✓ Current UK coins and banknotes
- ✓ Any old British & Irish money
- ✓ Even obsolete currency!

Currency services supplied by  **cash4coins**

Ways you can support us...



We understand that the current economic situation is making money tight for a lot of people. Below are some ways you can still support us with your existing shopping. Each of the methods listed below costs you nothing extra!

You can raise FREE donations for IIH UK every time you shop online. Just use easyfundraising.org.uk. Over 4,000 shops and sites will donate, including all the big names like John Lewis, BT, Expedia, Argos, ASOS, Just Eat, Uswitch and many more!

www.easyfundraising.org.uk/causes/iihuk/

Make us your favourite charity and there are 3 ways to help.

You can donate a percentage of what you sell directly to IIH UK.

You can find items on our page listed with a donation to IIH UK or at the checkout for any item you can add a donation.

www.charity.ebay.co.uk/charity/IIH-UK/49628

Unfortunately Amazon Smile closed down on the 20th February 2023, so this can no longer be used.

Thank you to everyone who has been using Amazon Smile previously.

You **Shop**
Retailers **Donate**
To **Causes**
For **FREE**



£31M
Raised



Support us



Help us raise funds!



How you can help...

♥ Find ideas and fundraising resources for your own fundraising events on our website including skydiving if you are feeling brave!

♥ https://www.iih.org.uk/section/6/1/how_you_can_help

♥ JustGiving - Donate or set up a fundraising page

at www.justgiving.com/iihuk

♥ Give as you live, search Idiopathic Intracranial Hypertension <https://www.giveasyoulive.com/login>

♥ Join our lottery and win up to £25,000! <https://allweatherslottery.com/iih-uk/>

♥ You can donate at the Charities Aid Foundation - www.cafonline.org/system/charity-search-results

♥ Create a birthday fundraiser on Facebook

♥ Donate with PayPal Giving - www.paypal.com/uk/fundraiser/charity/49628

♥ Selling on eBay? Why not give a percentage to IIH UK via eBay for Charities - www.charity.ebay.co.uk/charity/IIH-UK/49628

♥ Buy from our Teespring store - <https://iih-uk.creatorspring.com/>

♥ Text HOPE to 70331 to donate £3

We are grateful to everyone who has utilised any platform to help us over the years, if there are any other platforms you think we should join to raise funds, don't hesitate let us know!

Membership renewal Is now available

HERE



Socials

Twitter

IIH UK can be found on X as **@IIHUK**

Instagram

IIH UK can be found on Instagram as **@iihukcharity**

TikTok

Did you know we now have TikTok? IIH UK can be found as **@iihukcharity**

Visit our Teespring Store for clothing, mugs, bags and more



www.teespring.com/en-GB/stores/iih-uk



Did you know we have a subscription with Benefits & Work which allows our members to access their range of publications.

The informative guides cover a range of issues relating to disability and benefits.

These guides are available free of charge to Members request. Click [HERE](#) for details

Benefits and Work Guides you can trust



WWW



[IIH UK National Charity](#)

IIH UK National Charity is the main Facebook page for sharing information to everyone on Fb.



[IIH UK on Instagram](#)

We are new to Instagram but are slowly building our followers.



[IIH UK YouTube](#)

Our You Tube Channel is where you will find all of our educational video's and webinars.



[IIH UK Website](#)

Our website has three areas.

1. People with IIH.
2. Family, friends, carers.
3. Professionals.

It is where you can find all of our information leaflets, research news and members area.

Postal Address

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Bidisk
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Tyne & Wear
NE38 7JX



Email Address

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Online

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Twitter - @IIHUK
——
Fb - www.facebook.com/IIHUKCharity

WWW